

Amazon Lex: Fallback Intent vs. Error Handling

This quick reference sheet outlines the structural differences between the global Fallback Intent and local Error Handling (Slot Elicitation Retries) inside Amazon Lex.

Feature	Fallback Intent (<code>AMAZON.FallbackIntent</code>)	Error Handling (Slot Elicitation Retries)
Scope	Bot-wide (Global)	Specific to one Slot within an Intent
The Bot's Problem	It cannot match the user's phrase to any known intent in the system.	It recognizes the intent, but the user's input does not match the slot's expected data type.
Example Trigger	User says: <i>"Can you tell me a joke?"</i> to a banking bot.	Bot asks: <i>"What is your age?"</i> (expecting a number) and the user answers: <i>"Blue"</i> .
Configuration	Configured as a standalone, built-in intent in your bot.	Configured in the "Advanced Settings" of the individual slot itself.
Typical Resolution	Search a database, suggest available options, or transfer the conversation to a human.	Prompt the user again with more specific instructions (e.g., <i>"Please enter a 4-digit number"</i>).